BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Thu 22 Oct 2026, 23:50 Malaysia time (15:50 UTC)

BTC ~ $81,700

Latest seen 20:06-20:32 MYT (Yahoo/CoinGape) | ~-2.1% 24h

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral to mildly bearish	**Next 24h range:** $80,500 - $83,000	**Key floor:** $80,200-80,500 (ETF cost basis / repeated support)	**Big event:** Weekly expiry Fri 4pm MYT; $12.2B monthly on 30 Oct

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

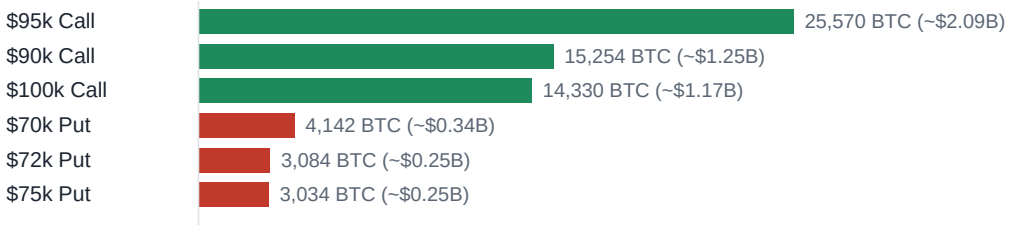
- **Next expiry:** Fri 23 Oct 2026, 4:00pm MYT (08:00 UTC). The Friday daily and weekly settle together; it is the only expiry inside the next 24 hours.
- **How big:** about **$1.23B** notional (Invezz, 22 Oct), ~14,759 contracts as of 17 Oct (CryptoTicker); max pain about **$82,000**, almost exactly at spot. Modest size, so a pin rather than a big catalyst.
- **Which expiry matters:** the **30 Oct monthly** (~$12.2B, P/C 0.52, max pain $79,000) is roughly ten times larger and is the one that shapes dealer hedging into next week's FOMC.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
23 Oct weekly	Max pain $82,000	~$1.23B total	Strike-level OI not readable this run. Max pain at spot = mild pull toward $82k into 4pm MYT Friday.
30 Oct monthly	$95,000 Call	25,570 BTC (~$2.09B)	Far above spot (+16%); a sentiment marker, not a near-term wall. Will likely expire worthless.
30 Oct monthly	$70,000 Put	4,142 BTC (~$0.34B)	Deep downside hedge; put OI is thin, so little dealer support until $75k-72k.

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.23B	n/a	~$82,000	Not published; most-traded calls are $85k-86k (30 Oct)
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.2B	0.52	$79,000	Calls $95k / $90k / $100k; puts $70k / $72k / $75k
Fri 25 Dec, 4:00pm (quarterly)	n/a	n/a	n/a	No fresh data this run

30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (Deribit, as of 17 Oct; USD at $81.7k)



How options affect the market now

- **Pin into Friday:** weekly max pain (~$82k) sits on spot. With only ~$1.2B expiring, expect a soft magnet toward $81.5k-82.5k into 4pm MYT, not a forced move.
- **Monthly pull lower:** the 30 Oct max pain is $79,000, about $2.7k below spot. As the week ends, hedging flows on the big book tend to lean toward that level if spot slips under $80.5k.
- **Upside walls are far away:** the giant call strikes ($90k, $95k, $100k) are 10-22% above spot. Near-term call interest clusters at $85k-86k (most traded per Nexo), which lines up with the $84.8k-85k resistance.
- **Thin put support:** the largest puts are $70k-75k. Between $80k and $75k there is little options-driven support, so a break of $80.2k could accelerate.
- **Sentiment:** monthly P/C 0.52 is call-heavy (bullish positioning), but short-dated puts trade richer than calls (Nexo), meaning traders are paying for near-term downside protection.

- **Volatility:** implied vol is near 2026 lows (~35% on 16 Oct; implies ~1.8% or ~$1,500 per day). Low IV after a quiet expiry means a breakout, when it comes, can catch sellers of options offside.

Data note: the live Deribit API (index, DVOL, book summary) was not reachable this run. Option figures come from published articles (CryptoTicker 17 Oct, Invezz 22 Oct, Crypto Briefing, Nexo) and are the largest positions seen, not a live snapshot. USD sizes = OI x $81,700.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC hit a session high of **$84,856** on Wed 21 Oct (Coinbase) but failed again below the $85k zone, then slid ~3%, its largest one-day drop in two weeks.
- Overnight low **$81,546** (5:10am ET); the latest prices seen were **$81,619** at 8:06pm MYT and ~**$81,760** at 8:32pm MYT.
- Drivers: Brent above $111-112 on reports of US-Israeli plans for new Iran strikes after the midterms, a tech/AI selloff (Nasdaq futures -2%, Kospi -3.5%, China CSI 300 in a bear market) and 10-year yields ~5.13%.
- BTC dominance is near 60% (highest since May): altcoins are falling faster; traders are hiding in BTC rather than leaving crypto.
- Range context: BTC has held $79.7k-80.5k on repeated pullbacks this month and failed at $84k-87k each time.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$84,800 - $85,000	Wed high and repeated failure point; near-term call interest at $85k-86k
Resistance 1	$83,500	Breakdown level of Thursday; reclaim opens $85k (CoinGape)
Pivot	$82,000	Weekly max pain and broken support; above = range, below = sellers in control
Support	$80,200 - $80,500	Glassnode ETF/treasury cost basis ~$80.2k; $80.5k held on repeated rebounds
Support 2	$79,000 - $79,700	Monthly max pain $79k; $79,676 held through three pullbacks (Invezz)
Deep risk	$75,000 - $78,000	Break opens $78k (CoinGape); first meaningful put OI at $75k-72k

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	$53.66B (21-22 Oct)	Up 4.2% from 12 Oct low; contracts roughly flat as price fell = price-driven move (Nexo)
Funding rates	Near zero	No crowded longs; leveraged longs being trimmed, not a squeeze set-up
BTC liquidations (24h)	~$119M (+80%)	Long-led unwind on the drop below $82k (CoinGape, 22 Oct)
Long/short ratio	1.0133	Balanced positioning
Spot BTC ETF flows	+$526.6M / +$23.2M / +$528.4M	19 / 20 / 21 Oct (SoSoValue via TFTC); 3 straight inflow days, ~$1.08B week to date
Implied / realised vol	IV ~35% (16 Oct); 28d RV 1.2%	Both near 2026 lows (TokenPost, K33)
Fear & Greed	68 (Greed) at 00:00 UTC 22 Oct	Reading pre-dates the selloff; likely lower now
BTC dominance	~60%	Flight to quality within crypto

4. News and macro

- **Iran / oil:** NYT reports US and Israeli militaries have plans for renewed strikes on Iran after the November midterms; Trump says no bombing before the midterms. Brent held above $111-112, feeding inflation worries.
- **Equities / AI:** Tesla's Q3 revived doubts about AI spending; Asian tech sold off and China's CSI 300 entered a bear market. Nasdaq 100 futures were down almost 2% early Thursday.

- **Rates:** 20-year Treasury auction cleared at 5.469%; 10-year ~5.13%. Fed is in blackout until 29 Oct; markets expect a hold next week and price a December hike.
- **China:** authorities moved to seize 61,800+ BTC tied to a ~$5.7B fraud case (CoinDesk) - a potential supply overhang headline.
- **Institutional:** Standard Chartered to acquire Zodia Custody; German savings banks launched BTC trading; Swiss FINMA approved a first retail spot BTC ETF.
- **Regulation:** US OCC finalised GENIUS Act stablecoin rules (effective 18 Jan 2027); Coinbase Ireland fined $3.6M by the Central Bank of Ireland.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Fri 23 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit weekly BTC options expiry (~$1.23B, max pain ~$82k)
Fri 23 Oct, 9:45pm	US S&P Global flash PMIs (October)
Fri 23 Oct, 10:00pm	University of Michigan final October consumer sentiment
Tue 27 - Wed 28 Oct	FOMC meeting; decision Thu 29 Oct 2:00am MYT, press conference 2:30am (hold expected)
Next week (dates TBC)	ECB and Bank of Japan decisions (holds expected)
Thu 29 Oct (time TBC)	US core PCE (per Nexo)
Fri 30 Oct, 4:00pm	Deribit monthly expiry (~$12.2B, P/C 0.52, max pain $79k)
Tue 3 Nov	US midterm elections (Iran-strike timing linked to this)
Fri 6 Nov, 9:30pm	US nonfarm payrolls (October)

5. Summary and prediction

BTC rejected again at the $84.8k-85k ceiling and dropped to ~$81.7k on a risk-off mix of $111+ oil, Iran-strike reports, an AI-led equity selloff and 5%+ yields. The structure is still a range ($80k-85k) rather than a breakdown: funding is flat, open interest in contracts barely moved, and ETFs took in about $1.08B this week. Options add a soft pin near $82k into Friday's weekly expiry, while the much larger 30 Oct monthly (max pain $79k, thin puts above $75k) leaves downside less protected if $80.2k gives way. **24h call: range-bound $80,500-$83,000 with a slight downside lean; a 4h close below $80,200 is the trigger that changes the picture.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range / pin	50%	$80,500 - $83,000	Expiry pin near $82k, oil stable, no new Iran headlines; ETFs stay positive
Bullish: reclaim	20%	$83,000 - $85,000	4h close above $83,500; oil eases, Nasdaq rebounds, another $500M+ ETF day
Bearish: support break	30%	$78,500 - $80,500	4h close below $80,200; Brent new highs, equities extend losses, ETF outflows

- **Breakdown signal:** 4h close below $80,200 with rising open interest and negative funding - points to $79k (monthly max pain) then $78k.
- **Breakout signal:** reclaim of $83,500 with spot volume and positive ETF prints - opens $84.8k-85k; above $85k the $86.5k-87.5k sell zone is next.
- Next report: Fri 23 Oct, 7:50am MYT

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